



Kinfield Navigator

Family Action Plan for Peter Aldous

Prepared for Mark Aldous, son

Date	22 September 2026
Plan version	Version 1.0
Plan reference	AP-PA7902

This plan contains personal information. Please share it only with people involved in Peter's care.

Your plan at a glance

KEY PRIORITIES

- Now** Make the home safer
- Now** Get a needs assessment
- Now** Respond to memory changes
- Now** Arrange regular breaks for the carer
- Now** Support Ruth as the main carer

WHAT NEEDS ATTENTION

- Make the home safer
- Get a needs assessment
- Respond to memory changes
- Arrange regular breaks for the carer
- Support Ruth as the main carer
- Put legal decision-making in place

22 actions in this plan, 12 to start now.

RECOMMENDED NEXT STEP

Arrange a personal alarm (within 2 weeks)

Your top priorities

- 1 Make the home safer** **Now**
You mentioned: leaves the stove on.
- 2 Get a needs assessment** **Now**
A needs assessment has been requested but has not happened yet.
- 3 Respond to memory changes** **Now**
Peter has a diagnosis of dementia.
- 4 Arrange regular breaks for the carer** **Now**
Ruth has not yet had a planned break from caring.
- 5 Support Ruth as the main carer** **Now**
Ruth (wife) is the main carer.

What you told us

Peter Aldous, 79, lives with their partner in a house in Tauranga.

Ruth Aldous (77) is managing some health concerns.

Peter walks independently.

Health conditions include type 2 diabetes.

The family has noticed noticeable memory changes, and there is a dementia diagnosis.

Current support: help from family.

Ruth (wife) is the main carer and describes the strain as high.

What matters most: keep Peter at home while it is safe and give Ruth regular breaks.

Notes from the family: Ruth has not had a full night's sleep in weeks.

Recommended next steps

PRIORITY	ACTION	WHO	WHEN
Now			
Now	Arrange a personal alarm Ask the GP whether a funded personal alarm is available, or compare private monitored alarms.	Family with the GP	Within 2 weeks
Now	Agree a plan for when Peter goes missing Keep a recent photo and description ready, consider a location device, and tell close neighbours.	Family	This week
Now	Walk through the home for hazards Check lighting, loose mats, clutter on floors, and how easy it is to get in and out of the shower and bed.	Family	Within a month
Now	Confirm the assessment date Call the NASC service to check the referral arrived and ask for a date.	Mark Aldous	This week
Now	Prepare for the assessment Write down the hardest parts of each day, recent events and what the family can and cannot do.	Family	Before the assessment
Now	Contact a local dementia support service Ask about education sessions, day programmes and support for family carers.	Family	Within a month
Now	Set up memory supports at home A large clock and calendar, labelled cupboards and a regular daily routine reduce confusion.	Family	Within a month

PRIORITY	ACTION	WHO	WHEN
Now	Ask about the Carer Support Subsidy Raise it at the needs assessment or call the NASC service directly.	Ruth	Within 2 weeks
Now	Book a first short break Start with a few hours or a day programme so everyone gets used to it.	Family	Within a month
Now	Book a health check for Ruth Mention the caring role, sleep and stress so the GP can help.	Ruth	Within a month
Now	Share caring tasks across the family Agree who covers appointments, shopping, paperwork and regular visits.	Family	Within 2 weeks
Now	Set up both EPOAs with a lawyer Book a lawyer and choose attorneys for property and for personal care and welfare.	Peter with family	Within a month
Soon			
Soon	Check current entitlements Ask Work and Income which allowances apply, such as help with extra costs from a health condition.	Mark Aldous	Within a month
Soon	Ask the GP about driving safety Discuss whether a driving assessment is needed.	Mark Aldous	Within a month
Soon	Make a one-page emergency sheet List medicines, conditions, allergies and contacts, and keep it on the fridge.	Family	Within 2 weeks
Soon	Agree a backup plan if the main carer is unwell Decide who steps in, and how respite could be arranged at short notice.	Family	Within a month
Plan ahead			
Plan ahead	Start an advance care plan Talk with Peter and the GP about what matters most, and write it down.	Peter with the GP	Within 3 months
Plan ahead	Write a simple money snapshot List income, savings, regular costs and the value of the home, so options can be compared.	Family or EPOA attorney	Within a month
Plan ahead	Find one regular weekly activity A club, class, church group or day programme that Peter would enjoy.	Family	Within 2 months

PRIORITY	ACTION	WHO	WHEN
Plan ahead	Check hearing and eyesight Untreated hearing or vision loss often makes social contact harder.	Peter with family	Within 3 months
Plan ahead	Have a family conversation about the future Talk about where Peter would like to live and what matters most.	Peter with family	Within 3 months
Plan ahead	Review this plan in six months Update the plan if anything changes sooner.	Family with Kinfield	In 6 months

Your action plan, by topic

Only the topics that apply to Peter are included.

Staying safely at home

Now

WHAT WE NOTICED

- You mentioned: leaves the stove on.
- Peter does not have a personal alarm to call for help.
- There have been times when Peter has left home and become lost or confused.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Small changes at home, such as working alarms, good lighting and a way to call for help, prevent many emergencies and make it more likely someone can keep living at home.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

- ☐ **Arrange a personal alarm** · Within 2 weeks · Family with the GP
Ask the GP whether a funded personal alarm is available, or compare private monitored alarms.
- ☐ **Agree a plan for when Peter goes missing** · This week · Family
Keep a recent photo and description ready, consider a location device, and tell close neighbours.
- ☐ **Walk through the home for hazards** · Within a month · Family
Check lighting, loose mats, clutter on floors, and how easy it is to get in and out of the shower and bed.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

Family and neighbours · GP or practice nurse · Occupational therapist · Fire and Emergency New Zealand

QUESTIONS WORTH ASKING

GP

- Would Peter qualify for a funded personal alarm, and how do we arrange it?

Occupational therapist

- Which changes in the home would make the biggest difference to safety?

Needs assessment

Now

WHAT WE NOTICED

- A needs assessment has been requested but has not happened yet.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Most funded support for older people in New Zealand, including home support, carer relief and residential care subsidies, starts with a needs assessment by the local NASC service.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

- ☐ **Confirm the assessment date** · This week · Mark Aldous

Call the NASC service to check the referral arrived and ask for a date.

- ☐ **Prepare for the assessment** · Before the assessment · Family

Write down the hardest parts of each day, recent events and what the family can and cannot do.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

GP · NASC service · Hospital social worker

QUESTIONS WORTH ASKING

GP

- Can you refer Peter for a needs assessment, and how urgent should we say it is?

NASC

- Can family be present at the assessment, and what should we bring?

USEFUL INFORMATION

How assessments work ^[1]

A NASC assessor visits to understand daily needs, health and support, then coordinates the services the person is eligible for.

Dementia and memory changes

Now

WHAT WE NOTICED

- Peter has a diagnosis of dementia.
- Peter has sometimes become lost or left home unexpectedly.

WHY THIS MATTERS

An early assessment opens the door to support, treatment of other causes, and planning while Peter can still take part in decisions.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

- ☐ **Contact a local dementia support service** · Within a month · Family

Ask about education sessions, day programmes and support for family carers.

- ☐ **Set up memory supports at home** · Within a month · Family

A large clock and calendar, labelled cupboards and a regular daily routine reduce confusion.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

GP · Alzheimers New Zealand or Dementia New Zealand local services · Older persons' mental health team

QUESTIONS WORTH ASKING

GP

- Could these changes have another cause, such as medication, infection or low mood?
- Should Peter be referred to a memory service or specialist?

USEFUL INFORMATION

Local dementia support [8]

Alzheimers New Zealand and its member organisations offer information, education and support for people living with dementia and their families.

OPTIONS THAT MAY SUIT

Shown because they match Peter's criteria, not as recommendations. Sample providers for testing.

Memory Café Network (community)

Matches: Location: Bay of Plenty; Dementia support; Availability: vacancy or capacity now

Respite

Now

WHAT WE NOTICED

- Ruth has not yet had a planned break from caring.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Regular breaks protect the carer's own health, and that is often what keeps care at home sustainable.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

- ☐ **Ask about the Carer Support Subsidy** · Within 2 weeks · Ruth
Raise it at the needs assessment or call the NASC service directly.
- ☐ **Book a first short break** · Within a month · Family
Start with a few hours or a day programme so everyone gets used to it.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

NASC · Day programmes · Residential respite providers

QUESTIONS WORTH ASKING

NASC

- Is Ruth eligible for the Carer Support Subsidy, and how can it be used?

USEFUL INFORMATION

Carer Support Subsidy [2]

Reimburses part of the cost of a break for full-time unpaid carers. It is allocated through a NASC needs assessment and can pay for a relief carer, a day programme or short residential respite.

Planning breaks [3]

The Ministry of Social Development's guide for carers explains respite options and how to plan them.

OPTIONS THAT MAY SUIT

Shown because they match Peter's criteria, not as recommendations. Sample providers for testing.

Coastline Respite House

Matches: Location: Bay of Plenty; Dementia support; Availability: vacancy or capacity now

Support for the family carer

Now

WHAT WE NOTICED

- Ruth (wife) is the main carer.
- Ruth is under a lot of strain and may be close to exhaustion.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Family carers often put their own health last. If the main carer becomes unwell, the whole care arrangement can fall apart quickly.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

- ☐ **Book a health check for Ruth** · Within a month · Ruth
Mention the caring role, sleep and stress so the GP can help.
- ☐ **Share caring tasks across the family** · Within 2 weeks · Family
Agree who covers appointments, shopping, paperwork and regular visits.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

Carer's own GP · Carers NZ · Wider family and friends

QUESTIONS WORTH ASKING

GP

- Can Ruth have a health check that takes the caring role into account?

USEFUL INFORMATION

Carers NZ [9]

Carers NZ provides information, advice and peer support for family carers.

WHAT WE NOTICED

- An Enduring Power of Attorney for property is not in place.
- An Enduring Power of Attorney for personal care and welfare is not in place.
- There is no advance care plan recording Peter's wishes.

WHY THIS MATTERS

An EPOA can only be made while a person can still understand it. Without one, the family may need to apply to the Family Court to make decisions, which takes time and money.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

- ☐ **Set up both EPOAs with a lawyer** · Within a month · Peter with family
Book a lawyer and choose attorneys for property and for personal care and welfare.
- ☐ **Start an advance care plan** · Within 3 months · Peter with the GP
Talk with Peter and the GP about what matters most, and write it down.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

Lawyer or trustee company · GP (for capacity questions) · Te Tari Kaumātua Office for Seniors

QUESTIONS WORTH ASKING

Lawyer

- What does Peter need to set up both EPOAs, and how long will it take?

GP

- Is Peter able to make and sign an EPOA now?

USEFUL INFORMATION

Two kinds of EPOA [5]

One covers property and money, the other covers personal care and welfare. A welfare EPOA only comes into effect if the person is assessed as no longer able to make decisions.

Making an EPOA [4]

Te Tari Kaumātua publishes the standard forms and explains how they must be witnessed.

Advance care planning [6]

An advance care plan records what matters most to a person about future care, so family and clinicians can follow their wishes.

OPTIONS THAT MAY SUIT

Shown because they match Peter's criteria, not as recommendations. Sample providers for testing.

Seniors' Legal Clinic (community law)

Matches: Location: Bay of Plenty; Availability: vacancy or capacity now

Government funding

Soon

WHAT WE NOTICED

- The family has some concerns about the cost of care.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Several government subsidies depend on assessments and applications that take time. Starting early avoids paying costs that could have been covered.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

- ☐ **Check current entitlements** · Within a month · Mark Aldous

Ask Work and Income which allowances apply, such as help with extra costs from a health condition.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

Work and Income · NASC · Budgeting services · Lawyer or financial adviser

QUESTIONS WORTH ASKING

Work and Income

- Which subsidies or allowances could Peter be eligible for now?

NASC

- Does Peter's assessed level of care allow a subsidy application?

Transport

Soon

WHAT WE NOTICED

- Peter still drives, although there are concerns about memory.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Losing transport often leads to missed appointments and isolation. Subsidised options can keep someone independent.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

- ☐ **Ask the GP about driving safety** · Within a month · Mark Aldous

Discuss whether a driving assessment is needed.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

Total Mobility agencies · Community transport services · GP (for driving fitness)

QUESTIONS WORTH ASKING

GP

- Is Peter still safe to drive, and should a driving assessment be done?

USEFUL INFORMATION

Total Mobility [7]

Subsidised taxi and ride-share fares for people who cannot use public transport safely because of an impairment. Eligibility is assessed by an approved agency and subsidies vary by region.

Emergency planning

Soon

WHAT WE NOTICED

- If Ruth became unwell suddenly, there is no backup plan for Peter's care.

WHY THIS MATTERS

A one-page emergency sheet and a backup carer plan save precious time when something unexpected happens.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

- ☐ **Make a one-page emergency sheet** · Within 2 weeks · Family
List medicines, conditions, allergies and contacts, and keep it on the fridge.
- ☐ **Agree a backup plan if the main carer is unwell** · Within a month · Family
Decide who steps in, and how respite could be arranged at short notice.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

Family · GP · Pharmacist

USEFUL INFORMATION

Emergency kits [11]

Get Ready explains how to prepare a household emergency plan, including medicines and mobility needs.

Financial considerations

Plan ahead

WHAT WE NOTICED

- Peter owns their home, which affects subsidies and how a move could be funded.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Retirement villages and residential care have very different costs and contracts. Understanding them early avoids rushed decisions.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

- ☐ **Write a simple money snapshot** · Within a month · Family or EPOA attorney

List income, savings, regular costs and the value of the home, so options can be compared.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

Financial adviser · Lawyer · Free budgeting services

QUESTIONS WORTH ASKING

Financial adviser

- How would each option affect Peter's income and assets over five years?

Social connection

Plan ahead

WHAT WE NOTICED

- Peter sees people less often than before.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Loneliness affects mood, memory and physical health. One regular activity each week makes a real difference.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

- ☐ **Find one regular weekly activity** · Within 2 months · Family

A club, class, church group or day programme that Peter would enjoy.

- ☐ **Check hearing and eyesight** · Within 3 months · Peter with family

Untreated hearing or vision loss often makes social contact harder.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

Age Concern · Local community groups · Church or cultural groups

USEFUL INFORMATION

Visiting services [10]

Age Concern runs visiting and social programmes for older people in many parts of New Zealand.

OPTIONS THAT MAY SUIT

Shown because they match Peter's criteria, not as recommendations. Sample providers for testing.

Memory Café Network (community)

Matches: Location: Bay of Plenty; Dementia support; Availability: vacancy or capacity now

WHAT WE NOTICED

- Peter's goals: keep Peter at home while it is safe and give Ruth regular breaks.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Talking about wishes before a crisis means future decisions reflect what Peter wants.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

- ☐ **Have a family conversation about the future** · Within 3 months · Peter with family
Talk about where Peter would like to live and what matters most.
- ☐ **Review this plan in six months** · In 6 months · Family with Kinfield
Update the plan if anything changes sooner.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

Family · GP · Kinfield navigator

Action checklist

Tick actions off as they are done. Your navigator can update the plan with your progress.

Now

- ☐ Arrange a personal alarm · Within 2 weeks
- ☐ Agree a plan for when Peter goes missing · This week
- ☐ Walk through the home for hazards · Within a month
- ☐ Confirm the assessment date · This week
- ☐ Prepare for the assessment · Before the assessment
- ☐ Contact a local dementia support service · Within a month
- ☐ Set up memory supports at home · Within a month
- ☐ Ask about the Carer Support Subsidy · Within 2 weeks
- ☐ Book a first short break · Within a month
- ☐ Book a health check for Ruth · Within a month
- ☐ Share caring tasks across the family · Within 2 weeks
- ☐ Set up both EPOAs with a lawyer · Within a month

Soon

- ☐ Check current entitlements · Within a month
- ☐ Ask the GP about driving safety · Within a month
- ☐ Make a one-page emergency sheet · Within 2 weeks
- ☐ Agree a backup plan if the main carer is unwell · Within a month

Plan ahead

- ☐ Start an advance care plan · Within 3 months
- ☐ Write a simple money snapshot · Within a month
- ☐ Find one regular weekly activity · Within 2 months
- ☐ Check hearing and eyesight · Within 3 months
- ☐ Have a family conversation about the future · Within 3 months
- ☐ Review this plan in six months · In 6 months

We can help you carry this out

Kinfield Navigator can help your family work through this plan: making calls, preparing for assessments and appointments, comparing options and updating the plan as things change.

Phone 0123456789 · **Email** plans@kinfield.example

Sources and important information

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3. Taking a break from caring (respite), Ministry of Social Development. <https://www.msd.govt.nz/what-we-can-do/community/carers/guide-for-carers/people/taking-a-break-from-caring-respite.html> (reviewed 22 September 2026)
4. Creating an Enduring Power of Attorney, Te Tari Kaumātua Office for Seniors. <https://www.officeforseniors.govt.nz/our-work/promoting-enduring-power-of-attorney/how-to-create-an-enduring-power-of-attorney> (reviewed 22 September 2026)
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6. Advance care planning, Health New Zealand | Te Whatu Ora. <https://www.myacp.org.nz/> (reviewed 22 September 2026)
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9. Carers NZ, Carers New Zealand. <https://carers.net.nz/> (reviewed 22 September 2026)
10. Age Concern New Zealand, Age Concern New Zealand. <https://ageconcern.org.nz/> (reviewed 22 September 2026)
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Plan AP-PA7902, version 1.0, issued 22 September 2026. Generated by kinfield-rules 0.1.0 with module set core-1ff0c435.

This plan gives general information based on what your family told us. It is not medical, legal or financial advice. Eligibility for funding and services is decided by the agencies involved, and details such as thresholds change over time. Please check with the relevant professional before making decisions.